

Hospital Workflow — Interview Guide

HospiCare · Hospital Management System (EMR & Pharmacy)
Prepared to map the real patient-care process before finalising the system.

Internship Project

How to use this guide. Take it to each member of staff and ask the questions in their section. Write answers on the dotted lines (or a notebook). The goal is to learn **who does what, in what order**, and the **clinical rules** (which tests follow which symptoms, and which drugs treat which diagnoses). The last two pages have tables to capture those rules — they will power the system's test/treatment suggestions.

1. Receptionist / Records Officer — first point of contact

1. What details do you record for a **new patient**? (name, date of birth, sex, phone, address, next of kin, blood group, known allergies?)
 2. How do you find a **returning patient's** file? Is there a patient card or number?
 3. Do you record the **reason for the visit**, or does the nurse/doctor do that?
 4. Is any **payment** collected at registration (e.g. a consultation fee)? How much, and how is it recorded?
 5. After registration, **where does the patient go next** — to a nurse, straight to the doctor, or to a waiting area?
 6. How are **appointments** handled today (walk-in only, appointment book, phone)?
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2. Nurse — triage & vital signs (key interview)

1. After registration, does the patient **see you before the doctor**?
2. Which **vital signs** do you measure? (temperature, blood pressure, pulse, weight, height, respiratory rate, oxygen saturation?)
3. Do you record the patient's **symptoms / complaint**, and in how much detail?
4. Do you decide how **urgent** a patient is (triage)? What categories do you use?
5. Can you **order any tests** yourself, or only the doctor?
6. Do you give any **treatment** before the doctor (injections, first aid, first dose)?
7. Are there **danger signs** that mean a patient must be seen immediately?

Common complaint → tests usually done (the nurse often knows these best)

For each complaint, ask: "which lab tests are almost always ordered?"

1. Fever / hot body → ...
 2. Headache → ...
 3. Cough / difficulty breathing → ...
 4. Diarrhoea & vomiting → ...
 5. Abdominal / stomach pain → ...
 6. Fatigue / weakness / pallor → ...
 7. Pregnancy-related visit → ...
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3. Doctor — consultation & clinical decisions

1. What do you **review first** when the patient comes in (vitals, history, previous visits)?
 2. How do you decide **which lab tests to order**? Are there standard "symptom → test" rules you follow?
 3. After results come back, does the patient **return to you**, and how do you receive the results?
 4. How do you reach a **diagnosis** and choose **drugs**?
 5. For the **most common diagnoses**, what are the first-line drugs and typical dosing? (see table on last page)
 6. When do you write a **referral** to another facility?
 7. Would a system that **suggests tests/drugs** from the patient's symptoms help you? What would make you trust it (or not)?
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4. Laboratory Technician — tests & results

1. Which tests do you perform **in-house**, and which are **sent out**?
 2. How do you receive a **test request** (paper form, verbal, patient brings a slip)? What is written on it?
 3. How are **results recorded** and returned to the doctor?
 4. What is the typical **turnaround time** for common tests?
 5. How do you know a result is **abnormal** (reference ranges)? Do you flag it?
 6. What are the **prices** of the common tests? (see table)
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5. Pharmacist — dispensing & stock

1. How do you **receive a prescription** (paper, patient brings it, electronic)?
 2. Do you dispense **exactly as prescribed**, or can you substitute a generic/alternative?
 3. How is **drug stock** tracked now? When and how do you **reorder**?
 4. How do you handle **expiry** — how are near-expiry or expired drugs managed?
 5. Is payment made **at the pharmacy** or at a separate cashier?
 6. Do you sell to **walk-in customers** without a prescription (over-the-counter)?
 7. Which drugs are **always in demand**?
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6. Cashier / Billing — if this is a separate person

1. What is **charged**, and at which points (registration, consultation, lab, drugs)?
 2. Which **payment methods** do you accept? (cash, MTN Mobile Money, Orange Money, other?)
 3. Is there any **insurance**, exemption, or credit arrangement?
 4. How is a **receipt** issued and recorded?
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7. Administrator / Management — oversight

1. What **reports** do you need (daily revenue, patient numbers, stock levels, staff activity)?
 2. Who should be able to **see or change what** (roles & permissions)?
 3. What are the biggest **pain points** with the current (paper?) system?
 4. How is patient **confidentiality** handled?
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Appendix A — Patient Journey (fill in the order of steps)

Walk one patient through from arrival to leaving. One row per step.

#	Step	Who does it	What is recorded	Payment here?
1				
2				
3				
4				
5				
6				
7				
8				

Appendix B — Clinical Rules (this powers the system's suggestions)

Table 1 · Symptom / Complaint → tests usually ordered

Symptom / complaint	Tests usually ordered
Fever	
Headache	
Cough / breathing difficulty	
Diarrhoea & vomiting	
Abdominal pain	
Fatigue / weakness	

Table 2 · Diagnosis → first-line drug(s) & dosage

Diagnosis	First-line drug(s), dose & duration
Uncomplicated malaria	
Severe malaria	
Typhoid fever	
Respiratory infection	
Urinary tract infection	
Gastroenteritis	

Table 3 · Lab test → price, reference range, turnaround

Test	Price (FCFA)	Reference / normal	Turnaround
Malaria RDT			
Widal test			
Full blood count			
Blood glucose			